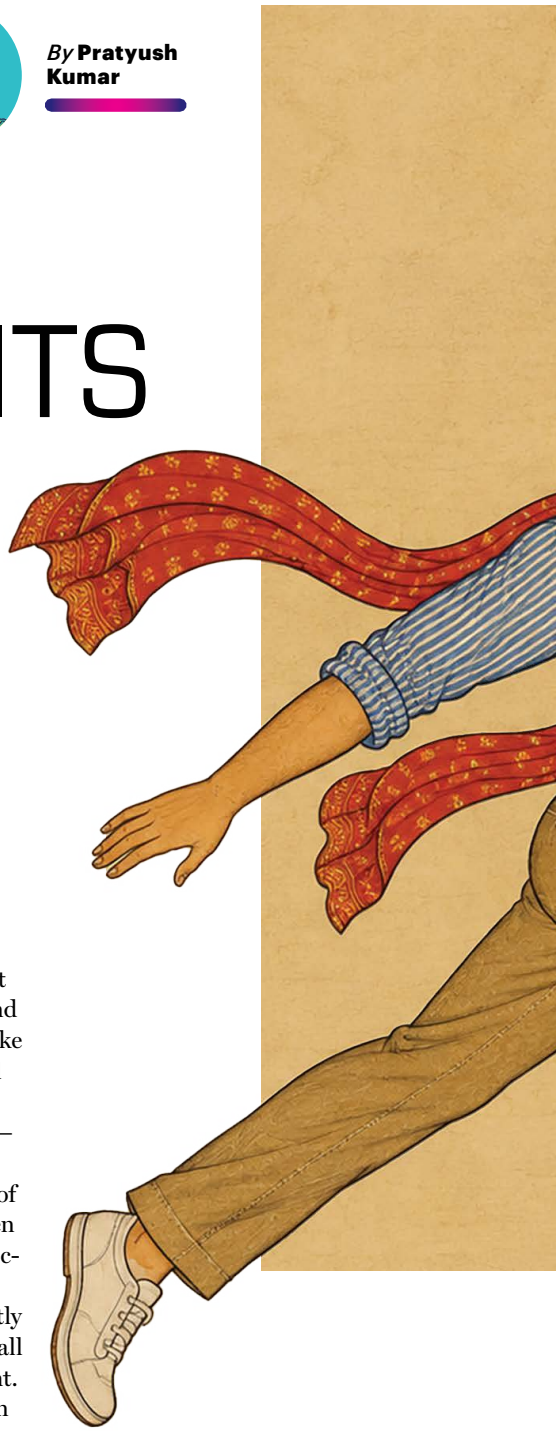


By **Pratyush Kumar**

WHY INDIA MUST BUILD ITS **OWN AI STACK**

INDIA'S AI FUTURE DEPENDS ON **BUILDING THE INFRASTRUCTURE, KNOWLEDGE AND TALENT** TO DEVELOP, IMPROVE AND SECURE INTELLIGENCE AT SCALE



Every time an Indian doctor corrects an AI's summary of a case file or a lawyer flags a misread clause, someone's model can get a little better. The question is whose? If India only buys access to foreign AI, its users will spend the next decade teaching other countries' systems while paying for the privilege. India must build its own AI stack because its place in the AI economy will depend on three capacities that cannot be bought: manufacturing intelligence at scale, improving it through use, and growing the people who advance it.

Manufacturing intelligence means being able to train, deploy and improve models that do useful work. That requires computing infrastructure, data, models and developer tools. India need not make every component itself, but it must have enough expertise and control across these layers to make its own technical choices. Global partnerships and open research should strengthen that capacity—not stand in for it.

The economic prize is a cycle of adoption and improvement. When people use AI at work, their corrections, expert judgements and the outcomes of real tasks show exactly where models succeed and fail. Call it the data dividend of deployment. With consent, rigorous evaluation and protection for confidential information, that experience becomes the training data and tests for the next generation of models.

But collecting interactions is not enough. Indian organisations must build the systems that turn experience into better models and they must own the resulting intellectual property. Otherwise, India supplies the demand and the feedback while the value builds up elsewhere. It would pay twice: once for access and again in knowledge given away. Owning model IP (intellectual property) lets Indian firms build products, set research priorities and earn from capabilities they helped create. Better models attract more use and the cycle turns again.

The same cycle must build

Illustration by NILANJAN DAS/AI